

The OBX Rental Owner's Operations Kit

THE COMPLETE KIT — 7 COMPONENTS

Six done-for-you templates built for the Outer Banks — turnovers, guest welcome book, maintenance, storm prep, vendors, and pricing. The system we wish every owner had.

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What's in this kit

Seven OBX-specific components. Print them, fill them in, and use them this season. Items marked ★ are the Outer Banks details most generic checklists miss.

- **The OBX Turnover & Cleaning Checklist**
- **The OBX Guest Welcome Book — Fill-in Template**
- **The OBX Seasonal Maintenance Calendar**
- **The OBX Storm-Prep Plan**
- **The OBX Vendor Contact Sheet**
- **The OBX Pricing & Seasonality Cheat Sheet**
- **The OBX Tech-Ready Rental Setup Guide**

This is an OBX Lot Solutions product. The advice is genuinely useful on its own — and when you'd rather not DIY, the same local team does the hands-on work. County tax/permit and insurance notes are starting points; verify current specifics with the county and your carrier.

The OBX Turnover & Cleaning Checklist

Part of the OBX Rental Owner's Operations Kit. A room-by-room turnover system built for Outer Banks vacation rentals — same-day weekend turns, salt-and-sand reality, and the details that protect your 5-star reviews. Print one per turn, or load it into your cleaner's app.

How to use: Hand this to your cleaning team and walk it once together. The goal is a turn that's repeatable by anyone, so the home is guest-ready whether your A-team or a fill-in does it. Items marked ★ are the OBX-specific ones most checklists miss.

Before you start (5 minutes)

- ☐ Confirm checkout happened / guest has left
- ☐ Note the next check-in time — back-to-back same-day turn? Prioritize accordingly
- ☐ Photograph any damage or items left behind **before** touching anything (protects your deposit claim)
- ☐ Open windows to air out (★ coastal homes hold humidity and odors fast)
- ☐ Start a laundry load first thing so it runs while you clean

Kitchen

- ☐ Dishes washed/put away; dishwasher run and emptied
- ☐ Counters, backsplash, stovetop degreased
- ☐ Inside microwave, oven front, toaster crumbs
- ☐ ★ Fridge emptied of guest leftovers; wiped; check freezer for ice buildup
- ☐ Coffee maker rinsed; restock filters, coffee, sugar, creamer pods
- ☐ Trash + recycling out; fresh liners; ★ confirm bins secured (raccoons/wind)
- ☐ Restock: paper towels, dish soap, sponge, trash bags, dishwasher pods
- ☐ Inventory count: glasses, mugs, plates, silverware, cookware (note shortfalls)

Bathrooms (repeat per bath)

- ☐ Toilet scrubbed inside + base + behind
- ☐ Shower/tub scrubbed; ★ check for sand in drains and corners
- ☐ Mirror, counter, sink, fixtures polished
- ☐ Floor washed
- ☐ Fresh towels (set per max occupancy + spares), hand towels, washcloths, bath mat
- ☐ Restock: toilet paper (2+ rolls/bath), hand soap, shampoo/conditioner/body wash, tissues
- ☐ Empty trash; fresh liner

Bedrooms

- ☐ Beds stripped, fresh linens, beds made hotel-style
- ☐ ★ Check under beds + nightstands for guest items / sand
- ☐ Dust surfaces, lamps, fans, headboards

- ☐ Closet: hangers counted, extra blanket + pillows present
- ☐ Windows/blinds wiped; ★ check screens for salt film and tears
- ☐ Floors vacuumed/mopped
- ☐ Trash emptied

Living areas

- ☐ Sofas/chairs vacuumed incl. under cushions (remotes, crumbs, sand)
- ☐ Surfaces, TV, electronics dusted; remotes wiped + working (fresh batteries on hand)
- ☐ Confirm wifi works + the network/password card is displayed
- ☐ Floors vacuumed/mopped
- ☐ Throw pillows/blankets straightened; décor reset to staging photos
- ☐ ★ Sliding-door tracks cleared of sand; door glass cleaned

★ OBX-specific exterior & extras

- ☐ Sweep sand off porches, decks, stairs, entry mats
- ☐ Outdoor furniture wiped + arranged; cushions present and dry
- ☐ Grill cleaned + propane checked (★ a dead tank is a common bad review)
- ☐ Rinse station/outdoor shower clear and working
- ☐ Beach gear inventoried (chairs, umbrella, cart, boogie boards) + sand rinsed
- ☐ Hot tub (if applicable): chemicals checked, cover secured
- ☐ Pool area (if applicable): skimmed, deck swept, gate latched
- ☐ Bikes/kayaks accounted for and secured
- ☐ Exterior trash/recycling bins staged for pickup day

Whole-home final pass

- ☐ HVAC set to owner default (★ don't leave it cold/off in summer — mold; or off in a freeze)
- ☐ All lights off, doors + windows locked
- ☐ Smart lock: ★ confirm prior guest's code is expired and next guest's code is set
- ☐ Smoke/CO detectors present and not chirping
- ☐ Welcome book + house rules displayed
- ☐ Welcome touch in place (see Guest Welcome Book) — small thing, big review impact
- ☐ Final walk-through against the staging photos: does it look like the listing?
- ☐ Photograph the finished home (proof of condition + fresh listing content)

Restock master list (keep this stocked)

Paper/cleaning: paper towels, toilet paper, tissues, trash bags, dish soap, dishwasher pods, all-purpose cleaner, sponges. **Bath:** hand soap, shampoo, conditioner, body wash, makeup wipes. **Kitchen:** coffee + filters, sugar, creamer, salt/pepper, dish sponge, foil/wrap, paper plates (optional). **Safety/utility:** batteries (AA/AAA/9V), light bulbs, fire extinguisher charged, first-aid basics.

Turn-day timing tips (★ OBX weekend reality)

- Friday/Saturday/Sunday turns stack up — book your cleaner standing weekly, don't scramble.
- A 3-5 bedroom OBX home is a **3-5 hour** turn for a team of two. Budget it.
- Sand and salt add ~20% to a coastal turn vs. inland — plan extra time for decks, tracks, and beach gear.

*Next: pair this with the **Vendor Contact Sheet** (your cleaner + backup) and the **Guest Welcome Book** (what the guest sees when the turn is done right).*

The OBX Guest Welcome Book — Fill-in Template

Part of the OBX Rental Owner's Operations Kit. A guest welcome book that cuts your "how does the X work?" messages, earns better reviews, and makes guests feel like locals. Fill in the [\[bracketed\]](#) fields, print it, and leave a copy in the home (and as a PDF in your listing). Written for Outer Banks rentals specifically.

Why this matters: the #1 driver of effortless 5-star reviews is guests who never had to ask a question. A good welcome book is the cheapest review insurance you'll ever buy.

Welcome to [\[Property Name\]](#)!

We're so glad you're here. This book has everything you need for an easy, great stay on the Outer Banks. If anything's unclear, reach us at [\[host name\]](#) — [\[phone\]](#) / [\[email\]](#). For emergencies, dial 911.

Address: [\[full address\]](#) **Wifi network:** [\[network name\]](#) **Password:** [\[password\]](#) **Check-out time:** [\[time\]](#) · **Check-in time:** [\[time\]](#)

The basics (fill in)

- **Door/entry:** [\[smart lock code instructions / key location\]](#)
- **Parking:** [\[where, how many vehicles, any permit\]](#)
- **Trash & recycling:** [\[bin location, pickup day, where to roll bins\]](#)
- **Thermostat:** [\[how to use, requested range — e.g. "please keep 68–74°F"\]](#)
- **Wifi not working?** [\[router location + "unplug 30 sec, plug back in"\]](#)

How things work (fill in the ones that apply)

- **TV / streaming:** [\[instructions, which apps, remotes\]](#)
- **Coffee maker:** [\[type + where supplies are\]](#)
- **Washer/dryer:** [\[location + detergent\]](#)
- **Dishwasher:** [\[pods location\]](#)
- **Grill:** [\[propane location/spare, cleaning request\]](#)
- **Outdoor shower / rinse station:** [\[how to use\]](#)
- **Hot tub:** [\[rules, temperature, cover instructions\]](#) (delete if N/A)
- **Pool:** [\[hours, gate/safety rules\]](#) (delete if N/A)
- **Beach gear:** [\[what's provided, where it lives, rinse-before-return request\]](#)
- **Fireplace:** [\[instructions / "decorative only"\]](#) (delete if N/A)

House rules (keep it friendly but clear)

- Quiet hours: [\[e.g. 10pm–8am\]](#)
- No smoking [\[/ designated area\]](#)
- Pets: [\[policy\]](#)
- Max occupancy: [\[number\]](#) — please no extra overnight guests

- Please rinse sand off at the outdoor shower before coming in ☐
- Before checkout: [\[start a dishwasher load, trash to bins, lock up, set thermostat to ____\]](#)

★ Your OBX local guide (the part guests love)

Customize these — the local touch is what makes a welcome book feel premium. Starter suggestions below; swap in your own favorites.

Beach access: Nearest access is [\[location/street\]](#). [\[Parking notes, lifeguard info, dog rules on the beach.\]](#)

Grab coffee / breakfast: [\[2-3 local spots\]](#) **Best casual dinner:** [\[2-3 spots — include a seafood pick\]](#) **Treat yourself dinner:** [\[1-2 nicer spots; note if reservations needed in season\]](#)

Groceries: [\[nearest Food Lion / Harris Teeter / local market\]](#) **Fresh local seafood:** [\[a fish market — a big OBX draw\]](#) **Rainy day:** [\[aquarium, lighthouses, Wright Brothers Memorial, shopping, brewery\]](#) **Kids / family:** [\[mini golf, ice cream, etc.\]](#) **Sunset spot:** [\[a sound-side spot — OBX sunsets are over the sound, not the ocean ★\]](#) **Surf / kayak / fishing rentals & charters:** [\[local outfitters\]](#)

OBX good-to-knows:

- Cell service can be spotty in spots — wifi calling helps.
- Sound side = calm water (great for kids/kayaks); ocean side = waves.
- Watch for **beach driving / 4WD** rules if near Carova/Corolla. [\[adjust\]](#)
- **Rip currents** are real — check flags; swim near lifeguards.
- Summer traffic on the [\[Bypass/Beach Road\]](#) is heaviest Sat (turnover day) — plan arrivals/departures around it.

If something's wrong

- **Maintenance issue (non-urgent):** text [\[host/phone\]](#) — we'll get on it fast.
- **Can't get in / lockout:** [\[instructions / call host\]](#).
- **No power:** check the breaker panel at [\[location\]](#); outages reported to [\[Dominion / co-op + number\]](#).
- **Water leak / urgent:** [\[shutoff valve location\]](#) + call [\[host\]](#).
- **Medical / fire / emergency:** 911. Nearest urgent care/hospital: [\[name + address\]](#).

Loved your stay?

A quick review means the world to a local owner and helps other guests find us. Thank you for treating [\[Property Name\]](#) like your own — come back soon! ☐

— [\[Host name\]](#)

Tip: keep a printed copy in a nice binder or framed one-pager in the home, AND attach the PDF to your booking confirmation so guests read it before arrival. Pairs with the Turnover Checklist (the book only works if the home matches it).

The OBX Seasonal Maintenance Calendar

Part of the OBX Rental Owner's Operations Kit. A month-by-month maintenance rhythm for an Outer Banks rental — built around the coast's real cycle: booked-solid summers, hurricane season, and the salt-air wear that never stops. Follow it and you trade expensive surprises for small, scheduled tasks.

How to use: Set calendar reminders for each block. Tasks marked ★ are coastal-specific. "DIY or pro" notes where it's worth hiring out. If your home is far away, this doubles as the scope you hand a local property-care team.

The guiding idea

A coastal rental takes more wear than a normal home *and* earns most of its money in a short window. So: **fix and prep in the shoulder seasons, protect during the booked season, button up for winter.** Salt, humidity, sun, and storms are the four forces — every task below fights one of them.

WINTER — January / February (slow season: deep maintenance)

Bookings are light; this is your repair-and-upgrade window.

- ☐ ★ Full interior deep clean + inspect for off-season humidity/mold
- ☐ Service/replace HVAC filters; schedule a pro HVAC tune-up before summer demand
- ☐ ★ Check for freeze risk — keep heat $\geq 55^{\circ}\text{F}$ or winterize lines if vacant
- ☐ Inspect roof, flashing, and seals from the storm season
- ☐ Touch-up paint, caulk, and any wood rot (salt + moisture accelerate it)
- ☐ Deep-clean or replace tired linens, towels, kitchenware
- ☐ Review last year's reviews — fix the recurring complaints now
- ☐ ★ Re-seal decks/exterior wood if due (coastal sun destroys finishes)

EARLY SPRING — March (get ready to earn)

- ☐ ★ Pressure/soft wash exterior — winter salt + algae buildup (*pro*)
- ☐ Wash windows + check screens (salt film, tears) (*pro or DIY*)
- ☐ Service the grill; replace propane
- ☐ Test all appliances, TVs, wifi, smart locks before peak
- ☐ Inspect + clean outdoor furniture; replace faded cushions
- ☐ ★ Hot tub/pool: open, service, balance chemicals (*pro*)
- ☐ Restock all consumables to full
- ☐ Pest control treatment before the season (*pro*)

SPRING — April / May (final prep + early bookings)

- ☐ Gutter clean-out + check drainage (*pro*)
- ☐ ★ Check AC is fully ready — first hot week sells out fast and AC failure = refunds

- ☐ Replace HVAC filters; confirm thermostat schedule
- ☐ Deep clean + staging refresh; new listing photos if anything changed
- ☐ Test smoke/CO detectors; replace batteries
- ☐ Confirm cleaner + vendor schedule locked for summer (see Vendor Sheet)
- ☐ ★ Stock hurricane/storm supplies before season (see Storm-Prep Plan)

SUMMER — June / July / August (booked solid: protect, don't disrupt)

Minimal invasive work — keep the machine running.

- ☐ ★ Hurricane season is live (Jun 1-Nov 30) — keep the Storm-Prep Plan ready
- ☐ Weekly: HVAC filter check in heavy use; confirm AC performance
- ☐ Hot tub/pool: regular service cadence (*pro/weekly*)
- ☐ Between turns: quick maintenance sweeps (see Turnover Checklist)
- ☐ Monitor reviews in real time; fix issues same-week
- ☐ ★ Keep an eye on the tropics; pre-position storm prep when a system forms
- ☐ Mid-season exterior rinse if salt/algae returns (*pro*)

EARLY FALL — September / October (peak storm risk + shoulder bookings)

- ☐ ★ Peak hurricane months — Storm-Prep Plan on standby, supplies stocked
- ☐ Post-storm inspections as needed (document everything)
- ☐ HVAC: switch-season check
- ☐ Gutter clean after any storms; clear debris
- ☐ ★ Deck/exterior wash to clear summer salt + sunscreen grime (*pro*)
- ☐ Begin booking winter repair projects with vendors

LATE FALL / EARLY WINTER — November / December (wind down + protect)

- ☐ ★ Winterize if going vacant: heat $\geq 55^{\circ}\text{F}$ or drain lines; protect pipes
- ☐ Hot tub/pool: winter service or close (*pro*)
- ☐ Final gutter clean before winter
- ☐ Bring in/secure outdoor furniture + beach gear for the season
- ☐ ★ Check all seals, weatherstripping, storm shutters before winter storms
- ☐ Deep clean; assess what needs replacing in the Jan/Feb window
- ☐ Holiday booking? Confirm heat, safety, welcome book current

Recurring (year-round, regardless of month)

- HVAC filters: every 1-3 months (more in heavy summer use)
- Smoke/CO detectors: test quarterly, batteries 2x/year
- Pest monitoring: ongoing
- ★ Exterior salt/algae: watch and wash as needed — the coast never stops

- Review every guest review for maintenance signals

*Pairs with: the **Storm-Prep Plan** (the June–Nov backbone), the **Vendor Contact Sheet** (who does the "pro" tasks), and the **Turnover Checklist** (the between-guest version of this).*

The OBX Storm-Prep Plan

Part of the OBX Rental Owner's Operations Kit. A before-during-after hurricane and storm plan for an Outer Banks rental — the barrier-island reality that hurricane season (June 1–Nov 30) is part of your operating calendar, not a rare event. Decide who does what now, while it's calm.

The one rule: make the plan *before* you need it. The owners who handle storms well decided in May who secures the house, where the supplies are, and how guests get notified. Fill in the [\[brackets\]](#) and keep this where your team can find it.

Your storm contacts (fill in now)

- **Owner/manager:** [\[name / phone\]](#)
- **Local boots-on-the-ground** (secures + checks the home): [\[name / phone\]](#)
- **Insurance agent + policy #:** [\[name / phone / policy\]](#)
- **Power company:** [\[Dominion / co-op + outage line\]](#)
- **Cleaner/turnover:** [\[name / phone\]](#)
- **Handyman/contractor:** [\[name / phone\]](#)
- **County emergency info / evac notices:** [\[Dare/Currituck county alert sign-up\]](#)

BEFORE THE SEASON (do once, in May)

- ☐ Confirm insurance is current; understand wind/flood coverage and your deductible
- ☐ ★ Photograph the entire property inside + out (dated) for claims baseline
- ☐ Stock storm supplies (list below) and know where they're stored
- ☐ Confirm who secures the home if a storm comes while it's rented or vacant
- ☐ ★ Check shutters/coverings, straps, and that loose items have a storage spot
- ☐ Sign up for county emergency alerts
- ☐ Draft your guest storm-communication message (template below)
- ☐ Know your evacuation reality: ★ OBX visitor/resident evacuations are ordered separately — guests usually must leave first

WHEN A STORM IS FORECAST (48-72 hours out)

- ☐ Track the system; watch for county evacuation orders
- ☐ ★ Contact current/upcoming guests — send the storm message; coordinate departure or cancellation per your policy
- ☐ Secure or store: outdoor furniture, grills, umbrellas, beach gear, décor, trash bins
- ☐ Install/confirm shutters or window coverings
- ☐ ★ Shut off water at the main if the home will be empty (burst line in an outage is a top claim)
- ☐ Charge devices; check battery backups, sump pump, flashlights
- ☐ Set fridge/freezer cold; consider what's perishable
- ☐ Confirm your local contact is ready to act
- ☐ ★ Final photos of secured condition

DURING / IMMEDIATELY AFTER

- ☐ Do not enter until it's safe and access is reopened (bridges/roads close)
- ☐ Monitor remote sensors/cameras if installed (power-loss, leak, temp)
- ☐ Coordinate your local contact for first safe inspection

AFTER THE STORM

- ☐ ★ Get eyes on the property fast — early damage is cheaper and better for the claim
- ☐ Document everything (photo/video) **before** any cleanup
- ☐ Check: roof, windows, water intrusion, flooding, power, HVAC restart
- ☐ Clear debris before it causes drainage/pest issues
- ☐ File insurance claim promptly with your documentation
- ☐ ★ Assess re-rentability; update calendar and notify affected guests
- ☐ Restock any used storm supplies

Storm supply kit (keep stocked Jun-Nov)

Flashlights + batteries · battery/crank radio · first-aid kit · bottled water · basic tools · tarps + rope · duct tape · trash bags · phone power banks · manual can opener · shutoff/water-main tool · printed copy of this plan + contacts.

Guest storm-communication template (fill in + keep ready)

Hi [\[guest name\]](#), we're monitoring [\[storm name\]](#) closely. The safety of our guests comes first. [\[Dare/Currituck\]](#) County has issued a [\[mandatory evacuation / warning\]](#) effective [\[date/time\]](#), which means guests need to depart by [\[time\]](#). Please secure your belongings and travel safely. Regarding your remaining nights, [\[our policy / refund / reschedule details\]](#). We're here if you have any questions — [\[phone\]](#). Thank you for understanding; the Outer Banks will be here waiting when it's safe to return. ☐

Tip: know your cancellation/refund stance for mandatory evacuations BEFORE the season — and consider whether to require/recommend travel insurance in your listing.

★ Smart monitoring makes this far easier

If your home is hours away, sensors change the game during a storm: a water-leak sensor, a temperature monitor, a power-loss alert, and a camera let you watch your home through the event from anywhere — *if* the internet stays up (backup internet like Starlink keeps it reporting when cable fails). Monitoring tells you something's wrong; a local contact fixes it. The two together are the real storm plan.

*Pairs with: the **Vendor Contact Sheet** (your boots-on-the-ground), the **Seasonal Calendar** (storm prep is baked into Jun-Nov), and the **Welcome Book** (guest emergency info).*

The OBX Vendor Contact Sheet

Part of the OBX Rental Owner's Operations Kit. One page that turns "who do I call?" panic into a 10-second lookup. Fill it in once, keep it in the home and on your phone, and share it with anyone who helps manage the property. On the Outer Banks — where reliable local help is the scarce resource — having a vetted bench before you need it is half the battle.

How to use: fill in your vetted vendors below. For each, note a **primary and a backup** — the #1 OBX operating lesson is that the busy season strains every vendor, so a backup is not optional. ★ marks the ones you'll call most.

★ Core team (you'll use these constantly)

Role	Primary (name / phone / email)	Backup	Notes (rate, hours, lead time)
★ Cleaning / turnover			
★ Home-watch / property checks			
★ Handyman / general repairs			
★ HVAC			
Plumber			
Electrician			

Property & exterior

Role	Primary	Backup	Notes
Pressure/soft washing			
Gutter cleaning			
Landscaping / yard			
Pest control			
Pool service			
Hot tub service			
Junk removal / clean-outs			

Role	Primary	Backup	Notes
Pressure-treated/deck repair			

Tech & systems

Role	Primary	Backup	Notes
Wifi / internet (ISP acct #)			
Smart locks / cameras / AV			
Starlink / backup internet			
Appliance repair			
Locksmith			

Utilities & accounts

Utility	Provider	Account #	Phone
Electric (Dominion / co-op)			
Water / sewer			
Internet			
Propane / gas			
Trash / recycling			

Emergency & official

Need	Contact	Phone
Emergency	911	911
Non-emergency police		
Nearest hospital / urgent care		
County emergency management (Dare/Currituck)		

Need	Contact	Phone
Insurance agent + policy #		
Restoration / water-damage (24hr)		

★ OBX vendor tips (the local reality)

- **Book the busy-season standing slots early.** Good cleaners and pool/hot-tub services fill up by spring — lock weekly slots before May.
- **Always have a backup.** Weekend turnover demand means your primary will sometimes be unavailable exactly when you need them.
- **Vet for reliability over price.** In a market short on dependable labor, the cheap vendor who no-shows costs you a guest refund and a bad review.
- **One local who does multiple things is gold** — washing + junk + checks under one number cuts your vendor list and your stress.
- **Keep this sheet current** — re-verify numbers each spring before the season.

This sheet is most valuable when your "home-watch," "washing," "junk," and "tech" rows point to people you trust. If you don't have those locked yet, that's exactly the gap a reliable local property-care company fills.

The OBX Pricing & Seasonality Cheat Sheet

Part of the OBX Rental Owner's Operations Kit. How Outer Banks vacation-rental demand actually moves through the year, and a simple framework to price for it. This is a planning tool, not financial advice — your numbers depend on your home, location, and amenities. Use it to build a pricing rhythm you can adjust from real booking data.

The core idea: OBX rental demand is dramatically seasonal. A huge share of annual revenue is earned in a short summer window, so smart pricing means charging what summer will bear, filling the shoulders aggressively, and not leaving the off-season empty when a little discount would book it.

The OBX demand curve (general pattern)

Season	Months	Demand	Pricing posture
Peak summer	mid-June – mid-August	Highest — books earliest, Sat-Sat weeks	Top rates; 7-night Sat-Sat minimums; raise as you fill
Shoulder (early)	late April – early June	Strong, growing	Strong rates; flexible minimums; capture early birds + events
Shoulder (late)	late August – October	Strong (warm water, fewer crowds)	Near-peak early Sept; ease down through Oct; promote "secret season"
Off-season	November – March	Low	Discount to fill; flexible/short stays; monthly/snowbird angle; holidays spike

Key dynamics to price around:

- ★ **Summer is Saturday-to-Saturday week territory** — most OBX homes rent full weeks in peak, not nights.
- ★ **Late summer/early fall is underrated** — water's warm, crowds thin, families with no school-age kids and couples book it. Don't crater your rate Sept 1.
- ★ **Booking lead time is long for summer** — peak weeks book months ahead (winter/spring). Have next summer's calendar and rates open early.
- ★ **Events move the needle** — fishing tournaments, festivals, marathons, holidays. Keep a local-events list and price up around them.
- ★ **Off-season isn't hopeless** — remote workers, snowbirds, holiday gatherings, and shorter getaways will book a well-priced winter home; an empty home earns nothing.

A simple pricing framework (4 steps)

1. Set your peak-week anchor. Research comparable OBX homes (same area, bedrooms, amenities — pool/hot tub/oceanfront move price a lot) for a peak-July week. That's your top rate.

2. Build the seasonal ladder off the anchor. A rough starting scaffold to then tune with data:

- Peak summer: 100% (anchor)
- Early/late shoulder: ~70-85%
- Off-season: ~40-55%
- Holidays (off-season spikes): bump toward shoulder pricing

(These are starting ratios to adjust — your real numbers come from how fast you fill.)

3. Adjust with live signals. Filling fast for a week 4 months out? You underpriced — raise it. Two weeks out and empty? Drop it or open shorter stays. Let the calendar tell you.

4. Account for your costs per booking. Cleaning/turnover, supplies, management/listing fees, maintenance reserve, taxes (★ NC + county occupancy taxes apply — confirm current rates with the county). Know your **net** per booking, not just the headline nightly rate.

Minimum-stay strategy

- **Peak summer:** full-week, Sat-Sat (matches OBX turnover rhythm and demand).
- **Shoulders:** shorter minimums (3-4 nights) to capture long weekends.
- **Off-season:** flexible / short stays, even 2-night, to fill otherwise-dead dates; consider weekly/monthly for snowbirds.

Fees & the guest-math reality

- Be transparent — surprise fees tank reviews and conversion.
- Cleaning fee should ~cover your actual turnover cost (a coastal turn runs higher; see Turnover Checklist).
- ★ Factor occupancy taxes and platform fees into how your total price reads to a guest vs. competitors.

Quick "am I pricing right?" gut checks

- Booked solid months ahead? You're likely **underpriced** for peak.
- Lots of empty shoulder/off-season dates? You're likely **overpriced** for those, or need shorter minimums.
- Great reviews but soft bookings? Probably **price/visibility**, not the product.
- Bad reviews dragging bookings? Fix the **operations** first (the rest of this kit) — price can't outrun a 3-star average.

Pairs with: the whole kit — because the fastest way to justify a higher rate is a flawless operation (clean turns, great welcome book, zero maintenance surprises). Price reflects the experience; the rest of this kit builds the experience.

Note: OBX occupancy tax rates and short-term-rental rules are set by Dare/Currituck counties and can change — verify current rates and any permit requirements with the county before finalizing your pricing and listing.

The OBX Tech-Ready Rental Setup Guide

Part of the OBX Rental Owner's Operations Kit — the premium-tier bonus component. The tech that quietly runs a modern Outer Banks rental: what to set up, why it pays back, what you can DIY, and what's worth a pro. Built on the same OBX reality as the rest of the kit — salt, storms, and guests who expect everything to just work.

How to use: run the self-audit at the end to see where your rental stands, then work the stack in priority order. Items marked ★ are the OBX-specific ones. (Based on field notes from Jamieson Automation, the smart-home side of our local operation.)

Why rental tech matters (the honest version)

Guests don't notice tech when it works — they only notice when it doesn't. A lockbox code that fails, wifi that drops during a movie, an AC left blasting in an empty house. Each one is a 9pm message, a bad review, or a wasted power bill. Getting the tech right buys you **fewer headaches, lower costs, and better reviews** — and on a barrier island, it buys you eyes on your home when you can't be there.

The rental-ready tech stack (in priority order)

1. *Keyless entry (smart lock).** No lockboxes, no lost keys, no meeting cleaners with a spare. Codes that auto-generate per booking and expire at checkout. Payback: kills the #1 access headache and the lockout call.
2. *Reliable guest wifi.** The single most common connectivity complaint — and review-killer — is "the wifi kept dropping." Coverage to every room, not just near the router. Payback: protects your ratings; remote workers and streaming guests demand it.
3. ★ **Backup internet (the OBX piece everyone misses).** Cable drops on the Outer Banks — especially in the storms you most want to watch your home through. Starlink or automatic cellular failover keeps you connected and keeps your sensors reporting when the grid and cable don't.
4. *Smart thermostat.** Set temps between guests and stop cooling/heating an empty house. Payback: real energy savings + prevents the summer-humidity-mold and winter-freeze problems of a wrongly-set empty home.
5. *Leak & temperature sensors.** Water is the #1 destroyer of vacant homes. A cheap leak sensor and a temp monitor catch a burst line or failed AC before it becomes a five-figure claim. Payback: enormous, for very little money.
6. *Exterior cameras (privacy-first).** Entry and driveway only — never interior. See storm damage, confirm a contractor showed, check a delivery, from anywhere. Payback: security + remote eyes + dispute protection.
7. *Noise monitoring (privacy-safe).** Decibel-only monitors (no audio recording) that alert you to a party before it becomes a neighbor complaint or a fine. Payback: protects your permit and your neighbor relationships.

What pays back fastest

If you do nothing else: **smart lock + reliable wifi + a leak sensor**. Those three solve the most common complaints and the most expensive disaster, for the least money. Everything else builds from there.

★ The OBX-specific angle

- **Salt and humidity destroy cheap gear** — weather-rated exterior hardware earns its cost; bargain cameras corrode and die.
- **Storms take down cable and power** exactly when monitoring matters most — backup internet (Starlink) + battery backup keep you reporting.
- **Multi-property owners:** standardize the stack per door so every home behaves the same — codes, wifi, thermostats managed from one dashboard.
- **Connectivity is the foundation** — every smart device is useless if the internet's down, so fix the connection before buying gadgets.

DIY vs. pro (the honest line)

- **DIY-friendly:** plug-in leak sensors, temperature/humidity monitors, a basic smart thermostat (low-voltage), a single smart lock on a standard door.
- **Worth a pro:** whole-home wifi coverage, backup internet/Starlink, multi-camera (especially wired/PoE) systems, anything that touches the electrical panel, and multi-property standardization. A bad wifi or camera install generates callbacks all season — the install is where reliability is won or lost.

Want it installed right — not a drawer of half-working gadgets? Jamieson Automation (our smart-home side) does coastal rental-tech installs: keyless entry, reliable wifi, Starlink backup, cameras, and sensors, set up per door to actually keep working. Same trusted local operator behind this whole kit.

★ "Is my rental tech-ready?" self-audit

Score yourself — each "no" is an opportunity:

- ☐ Keyless entry with per-booking codes (no lockbox)?
- ☐ Wifi reliable in **every** room, tested under load?
- ☐ Backup internet for storms/outages?
- ☐ Smart thermostat you can set between guests?
- ☐ Leak sensor at every wet point (under sinks, water heater, washer)?
- ☐ Temperature monitor to catch a failed HVAC?
- ☐ Exterior-only cameras at entry/driveway?
- ☐ Privacy-safe noise monitoring (if local rules/neighbors warrant)?
- ☐ All of it manageable remotely from your phone?
- ☐ A local contact who can respond when an alert fires?

0-3 yes: big, cheap wins available — start with lock + wifi + leak sensor. **4-7 yes:** solid; close the gaps (usually backup internet + sensors). **8-10 yes:** you're running a genuinely tech-ready OBX rental.

A note on insurance: some carriers offer discounts for monitored water-shutoff or alarm systems — worth asking your agent, but confirm with your carrier; we don't promise a specific discount. Pairs with: the Storm-Prep Plan (sensors make storm season manageable) and the Vendor Sheet (your tech + responder contacts).